DESIG Registration Page Revision V3

David Shamlin, Oct 13, 2026

Key points to convey

Based on based on Sep 22 2026 1:1 discussion with Betina.

1. The primary/central purpose of the SIG: overarching theme is digital literacy.
2. History of this SIG and examples of what we have done/accomplished to date
3. Who is this SIG for
4. SIG policy/member expectations
5. Logistics: When & where the SIG meets

Draft

The Digital Explorers SIG provides a supportive safe space for OLLI members to stay abreast of digital technology trends and develop their digital literacy skills. We spend time in our meetings sharing things we do with our personal devices/apps and learning how to use our devices/apps more effectively.

A group of members who participated in the Fall 2025 *Tech Skill 101* course formed SIG formed in January 2026. The members that initiated the formation of this SIG were motivated to do so by their interests in (1) learning how to use their devices and apps more effectively and (2) stay abreast of digital technology innovations and trends. These folks wanted to build on the momentum they created in the *Tech Skills 101* course to continue to further develop their skills using their personal digital devices (i.e., personal computers, laptops, smartphones, and tablets). When Duke OLLI launched the new SIG enrollment process in August 2026, we publicly announced this SIG which led to doubling the size of the group!

In our 2026 meetings we studied

- How to organize and find personal digital assets like apps, files, apps, and email stored on our devices, in the cloud, and our inboxes.
- How to assess the quality, veracity, and trustworthiness of Internet sites and apps.
- Ways to protect of our online accounts using password managers, two-factor authentication, and passkeys.
- Methods to reduce the amount of junk/spam email that land in our inboxes.
- How search engines, recommendation engines, and news feeds work in order to get more value from them while avoiding "low quality" online content (i.e., identifying misinformation and disinformation online).

These studies have been prepared and led by the SIG leader who had a 35 year career in software engineering. In the second half of the year, we also began dedicating some time in each of our meetings to what we are affectionately referring to as "show-n-tell" where members share apps, internet sites, and online services they discovered and consider interesting, valuable, or just plain entertaining.

SIG members collaboratively chose our learning topics. We are currently considering repeat the "Tech Skills 101" course during the Winter 2027 term. The instructor of that course also happens to be the SIG leader and is revising the course with input/feedback from SIG members. While we have kept the SIG size small to date in order to balance member's varying interests/needs and skill levels, we are considering how we can increase the enrollment size to

allow more members to join by the time we begin the course in January 2027 while maintaining that balance.

The SIG will meet every Friday morning [provided we are able to reserve a room on that schedule and with agreement among current members] in the Erwin Mill building from 9:00 AM until noon (at the latest) during the Winter 2027 term. If you would like more information about this SIG's plan/direction to help you decide if you want to enroll, please send email to the SIG leader at olli.shamlin@gmail.com.